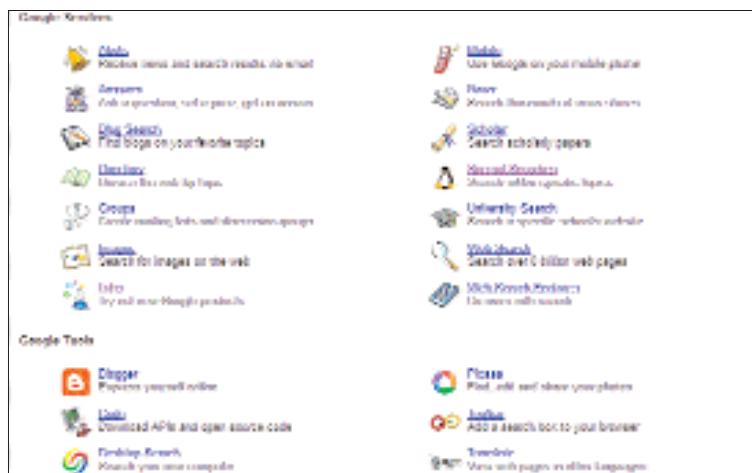




All of Google's More

make a little bit of money by placing ads in them. Of course, there is no limit to the money you can make from this service.

The service is very simple to understand: all a user needs to do, is register his or her site/blog, customise the ad placement and copy the HTML code onto his or her Web page. You get paid every time a visitor to your site clicks on an advertisement. The payment differs on the type of ad and the uniqueness of the click. This ensures that you can't make money by continuously clicking on the ads pasted on your site.

This service has attracted many high traffic Web sites such as Indiatimes and Rediff. It speaks volumes about the financial benefits of the service.

GMail, with all its bells and whistles, is already nipping at Hotmail's and Yahoo's heels. The unlimited and ever growing storage capacity, the invites and added features, such as auto text completion, spell check, etc., have made it one of the most widely used mail services around—rumoured security threats notwithstanding.

Next is Code—Google's offering for the open source movement. With projects and APIs (application programming interfaces) open for collaborative work, Code aims to give the open source movement a platform to work on. Just when other Internet companies thought they could make some moolah by selling IMs and VoIP services, Google came up with Talk, which is the latest IM to hit the Internet. A simple, bare bones messenger, Talk also provides VoIP services. Though still in the Beta stage, the tool has recorded massive downloads within a month of its launch.

In addition, Google offers a desktop search application, which is a Google Labs "Graduate". The novel indexing technique used by this application has made sure that you don't have to wait too long for local search results to show up. The Google toolbar too, can be integrated to your browser. The toolbar functions exactly like the ones offered by MSN or Yahoo!

Picasa, an online photo sharing application by Google, is quite handy if you are interested in putting up an online portfolio, or sharing photos of your vacation with family members across the globe. Google's translation tools let you translate text or entire Web pages. The combination of languages is impressive, but we believe there are better translation sites around on the Internet.

Blogger and Google Earth are two heavy duty tools offered by Google. While Blogger was bought over by Google after they acquired Pyra Labs, the company that created the blogging tool, Google Earth is a novel tool that lets you fly around a virtual globe that resides on your desktop.

An advanced version of Keyhole, Google Earth can be useful if you want to plan an expedition to any corner of the globe. It can also be used as a tool by pilots who want to simulate their flight plan and routes. Though the tool is a free download, Google also offers a professional version for \$400. This comes with a GPS application integrated into it, among other features such as high resolution printing and customer support via e-mail.

The End

With the Internet becoming a very integral part of our lives it isn't surprising to see Internet companies venturing into every sphere possible. We already look to the Internet to answer all our queries. Increased online transactions, collaborative working and other such activities too have spurred companies such as Google into offering a wide range of services.

With innovation being the key to survival, it is only natural that Google's basket of tools and services grow. We will learn to enhance our productivity by choosing and making optimal use of these tools and services available. Now how do we optimise our tools? We'll tell you that, but some other time. ☒

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